



Original Netflix content

Netflix has announced that it will be releasing 1,000 hours of original content next year, up from 600 hours this year. <http://dgit.in/Netfx1000>



Design Awards 2016

Here are all the folks that were honoured with 2016 Material Design Awards by Google at I/O 2016. <http://dgit.in/MatDesignAwd>

Bazaar

Nikon D500

The king of APS-C sensor DSLRs

The Nikon D500 presents a sturdy, tank-like build. Powered by a 23MP DX CMOS APS-C image sensor, the Nikon D500 borrows a number of elements from the flagship Nikon D5. What this means is an array of professional features in the body of a Nikon DX camera, fusing the essentials of convenient shooting and excellent image quality.

The Nikon D500 borrows a 153-point autofocus mechanism from the D5 and matches it up with excellent high ISO performance, making it great for professional sports and wildlife photographers. It matches the fast shooting ability with excellent high ISO performance, which aids low light and extreme light photography. Shooting at RAW, the Nikon D500's strongest aspect is how it retains the smoothness of colours and texture, even at ISO levels as high as 12800. At ISO 6400, the Nikon D500 easily surpasses its lesser-equipped brother, the Nikon D7200, producing a great balance of colour tone and noise suppression.

The tone of deep colours is less intense, but the vibrancy coupled with excellent dynamic range make up for it. You get bright, accurate whites, lilacs, greens and yellows, along with sharp blues and reds. Shadows are crisp, which combined with excellent ISO performance deliver brilliant shots in harsh light.

Saturation levels are maintained constant even at higher ISO, and the balance is optimally neutral. It is only beyond ISO 6400 that we see a change. The brilliant dynamic range also produces great overcast photographs, where the details of the sky are well-retained, along with the darker foregrounds. Center-weighted shots are well balanced in terms of colour, sharpness, vibrancy, tonality and low image noise, making the Nikon D500 the king of APS-C DSLRs.

The autofocus mechanism features 99 cross-type AF points. Among these, 15 AF points are f/8-compatible, giving fast, accurate focusing in low light. 55 of the 153 AF points can be manually selected. 35 of the selectable points are cross-type, nine of which are f/8 compatible, spread strategically across the frame. Regular shooting in well-lit conditions is fast, smooth and accurate. The joystick makes focus selection and locking easy, and in low light, focusing is



Price
₹1,32,950

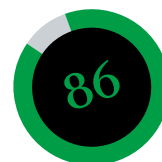
distinctly easier and faster than competitors. All of this combines with bigger buffer size to give fast shooting, and the D500 pushes RAW continuous shooting all the way to 10fps.

The Nikon D500 exhibits tank-like build quality, along with weather seal. The LCD is not swivelling but retractable, offering adjustable viewing angles. Screen resolution is now at a cracking 2.36 million dots, and the touch response is fluid and accurate. The arrangement of buttons and controls are distinctly tuned to favour professional photographers, and battery optimisations include a low power, monochrome LCD mode, eyepiece shutter and more. The Nikon D500 weighs 860 grams (CIPA) which makes it quite heavy, but neat elements like a robust hand grip, multi-way button and a convenient joystick make it fairly easy to use. Other neat touches include customisable buttons, ISO/exposure limit for Auto shooting and other fine optimisations in camera menu.

The D500 also gets Snapbridge, Nikon's proprietary, low power Bluetooth connectivity. It is battery-efficient and is the most convenient for transferring files on the go. However, image sizes for mobile transfer is capped at 2MB, and you will have to rely of Wi-Fi for full-size wireless transfer. Battery life is good, shooting about 1,000 photographs and 40 minutes of 4K resolution videos in one full charge.

To sum up, the Nikon D500 is one of the best DSLRs with an APS-C sensor. It aces photograph quality, it's an uber-fast shooter, and all the elements combine to make it the most serious prosumer-grade DSLR ever.

Souvik Das



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Specifications

Sensor type and size: CMOS, 23.5mm x 15.7mm; **Effective image pixels:** 20.9 million; **Viewfinder:** Eye-level pentaprism; **Frame coverage:** 100% horizontal/vertical (DX), 98% horizontal/vertical (1.3x crop); **Shutter speed:** 1/8000" to 30"; **Continuous shooting:** 10fps RAW; **Native ISO:** 100 to 51200; **AF mechanism:** Multi-CAM 20K module, TTL phase detection, 153 focus points (99 cross-type, 55 can be selected, 15 support f/8); **Monitor size and resolution:** 3.2", 2359k-dot TFT LCD, touch input, 100% frame coverage

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